BLOOM

Pitch Pack — for Stage 32

An animated musical feature. Prepared for development conversations, representation, and co-production interest.

1. LOGLINE

When a lonely girl discovers a strange boy who claims he used to be a tree, she must stop her father's aggressive development plans before an ancient forest's music and magic — and the boy — are lost forever.

2. SHORT SYNOPSIS

Thea is eight, whip-smart, autistic, and increasingly invisible to the father she adores. Since her mother died, he has poured everything into building a gleaming new town at the edge of an old forest — and though he never stops saying “I love you” on his way out the door, he has stopped being there to mean it. The night the whole town loses power, her father finally snaps at her, and she runs into the trees, where she meets a boy sitting calmly among the frozen machines. He tells her, gently, that he used to be a tree. She has no way to prove it to anyone. She believes him anyway.

What follows is a story about the cost of being believed. Her father, terrified he is losing his daughter to something he can't see or explain, pulls them further apart at the exact moment the forest itself comes under threat from the town's own expansion. A fire nearly takes everyone she loves at once — and in the middle of it, her father finally sees, with his own eyes, everything she had been trying to show him all along. Decades later, she is still keeping a promise to a boy who became a tree again: not waiting for him to come back, but waiting for the one night nature will finally let her say goodbye properly.

3. THE EMOTIONAL CORE

You don't have to understand something to love it. You only have to believe the person showing it to you.

That is the whole film in one sentence, tested from every angle: a daughter asking to be believed, a father learning how to believe her, and a boy who can only ever be truly known by someone willing to trust him without proof. Bloom is a fantasy built around a very ordinary ache — a parent and a child who love each other and still

can't quite reach each other — and it never once lets the magic answer the question for them. Believing has to be a choice every character makes for themselves, on purpose, at real cost.

4. MAIN CHARACTERS

Thea — The Girl

Eight years old, sharp-tongued, funny, and fiercely loyal once she trusts someone. Thea is written as an autistic child on purpose and with care — verbal, argumentative, prone to hyperfocus, and unmistakably delighted when she's happy (a full-body stim, both fists up, a delighted “eeeee” escaping before she snaps back to whatever she was doing). She wants to matter to her father again. She needs to learn that some truths can only be trusted, never proven — and her own temper, born from feeling unheard, is exactly what makes that lesson so hard to land.

William — The Boy

A soul who was once a tree, granted one moment as a human by the forest itself — however long the forest deems right. Peter-Pan energy on the surface — mischievous, restless, quick to laugh — with a real intensity underneath if something he cares about is threatened. He is ADHD-coded: hyper-observant, near-photographic memory, physically incapable of sitting still or of being lied to. He wants more time as a human. He needs someone to believe him without proof — which is exactly what makes the one time he has to withhold the whole truth from Thea cut so deep.

Dad — The Father

Middle-aged, goofy, physically affectionate, and the celebrated visionary behind the whole new town — a public performance of himself that used to be true at home too, before his wife died. He is ADHD-coded himself: overcommitted, always delivering, always one more project away from sitting still. He wants to build a better world for everyone. He needs to learn that “everyone” starts with the one person standing in front of him — and it takes nearly losing her to teach him that his fear for her was never something a schedule could fix.

The Forest

Not a character so much as the story's conscience — alive, watching, never fully seen or explained. It speaks rarely, almost too quietly to catch, and it lives by a single rule it never justifies: it grants one moment of being human, lasting however long it deems right, only to those it decides are ready. Nobody gets to ask why, and nobody gets to ask twice.

5. THE WORLD OF BLOOM

At the edge of a brand-new town built entirely to be perfect, there's an old forest nobody built — and nobody quite remembers to visit anymore. It's alive in ways the town can't be: its rivers run unnaturally clear, its animals move like they know something people have forgotten, and somewhere inside it, someone has been waiting a very long time for someone to believe in him.

The town represents everything progress promises — comfort, order, a brighter future. The forest represents everything progress quietly costs to get there. Neither one is the villain. That's the point: Bloom never asks anyone to choose between them, only to find where they can stand together.

6. THEMES

Connection vs. distraction — technology and overwork as the first things that break the bond between a father and his daughter, long before either of them notices it happening.

Belief without proof — she believes him before she can show anyone else; her father needs to nearly lose her before he can do the same.

Progress at nature's expense — the same unchecked growth that built the town keeps cutting deeper into the forest, and it's that appetite for more ground, not any single villainous decision, that leaves the fire somewhere it was ever able to happen at all.

Patience and waiting — the boy's decades of stillness mirror what it actually costs to wait for someone, properly, without giving up on them.

What's earned, not given — the forest grants nothing on request. Readiness, trust, and forgiveness all have to be arrived at, never simply handed over.

7. WHY THIS STORY MATTERS

Bloom is personal. Thea is written as autistic on purpose, drawn from my own daughter — not as a quirk or a plot device, but because I wanted a main character, a hero of her own animated musical, who happens to be autistic and is never once defined by it. William and Dad are both written as ADHD-coded, drawn from my own son and from me. None of it is spelled out on screen. It's simply true underneath the story of a girl and a boy who happen to believe each other instantly, in a way most of the people around them never quite manage.

Underneath the fantasy, Bloom asks a question every kid and every parent in the audience already knows the answer to, even if they've never said it out loud: what does it cost to be believed, and what does it cost not to be? It's a story about screens and distance and progress that never blames any of them outright, and a story about nature that never once lectures. By the end, it asks for nothing more than what any good family film has always asked: sit with someone long enough, and impossible things start to make sense.

8. SONGS / MUSICAL IDENTITY

Bloom is built as a film that argues through song. Most of its big numbers are duets — two people singing past each other before they finally sing to each other — because the whole story is about two kinds of truth-telling that keep missing their mark until, finally, they land. One melody carries the whole film: a wordless theme under the opening, sung in full for the first time by the forest itself at the fire, and returned to, wordless again, at the very end — except by then,

what began as a song of friendship has quietly become a way of saying goodbye.

The soundtrack is locked at 9 core tracks: “Bloom” (wordless opening theme), “Find Me,” “We See,” “Where Did You Come From,” “Why,” “Dream,” “World of Tomorrow,” “Let Them Know,” and the end-credits duet “An Angel.” Three additional short musical cues — “Meet Me,” “The Dash,” and “Find Them” — are fully written and already produced with finished demo mp3s. All lyrics for the full soundtrack are complete and written by me, with demos already recorded for several tracks — the musical identity of this film isn't a pitch on paper, it already exists and can be heard.

9. WHAT I'M LOOKING FOR

Bloom is a completed, thoroughly developed pitch — full story, character bibles, world bible, a complete first-draft screenplay, and a fully written soundtrack — looking for the right partners to carry it from page to screen. Specifically:

A producer or production company

To help package, finance, and physically guide Bloom toward production, and to help identify the right animation approach and scale for a story this personal.

A literary manager or agent

Representation to shop the project, and me as a creator, around the industry — someone to open doors this project hasn't had access to yet.

An animation studio or co-production partner

A studio experienced in family/musical animation, able to bring Bloom's world, characters, and tone to the screen at the level the material calls for.

A composer or music collaborator

To help score, arrange, and produce the songs beyond the demos already recorded — someone who can build on what's there rather than start from a blank page.

10. CREATOR BIO

I'm Mark Anderson, a writer, lyricist, and creator based in Barnoldswick, Lancashire. My work spans poetry, songwriting, and emotionally driven storytelling, with a focus on neurodivergent characters and honest family dynamics. I'm the creator of *Bloom*, an animated musical built from the ground up around my own family — every lyric in the film's soundtrack is mine, several songs are already recorded as finished demos, and the concept art for every major character was developed under my direction.

My creative work includes the *Ember Oracle* musical project, available on YouTube, Spotify, Apple Music and Amazon Music, with its own Facebook page; my non-fiction book *A Unified Theory*, published on Amazon and Kindle; and my contribution to the collaborative poetry anthology *Poetry for the Peers*. My writing blends emotional clarity with musicality, shaped by years of crafting poetry and lyrics that speak directly to lived experience.

Currently developing *Bloom* full-time, I'm actively seeking collaborators, representation, and production partners. I'm open to contact through any channel — email, social platforms, or direct calls — and welcome creative conversations at any hour.